

Glessner House

Exterior & courtyard audit

Photographic completion study • 1904-07-01 target • reviewed 2026-10-08

The house is recognizable, but substantial work remains before photographic quality.

The largest gaps are the courtyard enclosure and ground treatment, consistent roof/masonry rendering, distinctive joinery and ironwork, and believable vegetation/glazing. This is a review package only: no ticket was created, queued, claimed or edited, and no model or deployment was changed by the audit.

The interrupted T-2183 recovery was already completed in [PR #540](#). Its courtyard window/eave/copper fixes and dark-glass default form the baseline, not new proposed work. Audit checkout: ca405da1ae52f2cd15a5b64084ea259f12973e0d; recovered dev build: b307fa8e9ebc1f77ab4ac59d9474b8af63369edb. Browser captures use the locally served published app copy with unchanged scene materials and lighting.

Scope: house exterior, courtyard, stable, enclosure, exterior-visible glazing and immediate ground interfaces. Furnished interiors and new neighborhood construction are excluded. Existing adjacent-building tickets remain context dependencies. M/L effort labels are relative planning estimates, not scheduled commitments.

What the images establish

Area	Finding and confidence	Draft items
Evidence	Four Florian caption/image mismatches confirmed; one stable attribution disputed. Several preliminary designs and duplicate exposures need explicit evidence roles.	GA-01-02
Enclosure and ground	South courtyard wall absent in audit views; grass crosses the entry and carriage passage; court edging and curved hall-step cheek are unfinished.	GA-03-04, 16, 21-22
Roof and stable	Tile appearance changes markedly by plane/distance; cresting and edge details simplified. Stable cupola/loft fittings need a source-based refinement. Roof proportions and inferred stacks require measurement before alteration.	GA-05-08, 18, 20

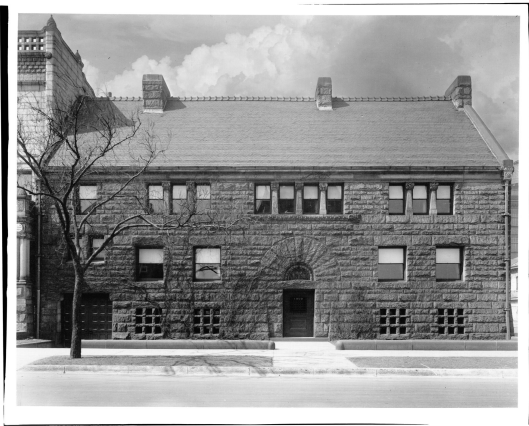
Masonry and openings	Street rock-face texture is noisy; courtyard material calibration must respect documented pink common brick and limestone. Door ironwork and unique window/stone profiles remain incomplete.	GA-09–15, 17, 19
Photographic finish	Bare vines, repetitive dark glazing, plain ground and uneven shadow readability keep the scene visibly synthetic.	GA-12, 22–24
Completion proof	Current audit is still-image full-desktop review, not a mobile/FPS or measured photogrammetry pass. A repeatable visual sign-off is still needed.	GA-25–26

Visual evidence

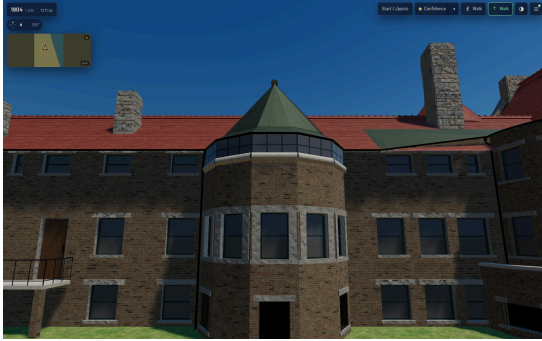
These pairs illustrate findings, not lens-matched measurements. Historical reference images below are HABS/public-domain records; restricted museum images are linked in the source ledger rather than redistributed. All images are shown unmodified.



Current model — prairie



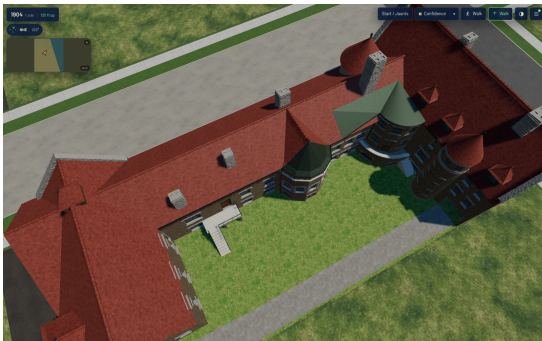
Reference #115 — Street facade: coherent coursing, openings and roof detail. See source ledger for date and catalog.



Current model — courtyard



Reference #118 — Courtyard: bow roofs, steps, brick/stone and planting. See source ledger for date and catalog.



Current model — roof



Reference #146 — Roof/courtyard: current overview versus HABS section. See source ledger for date and catalog.

Evidence corrections that must precede construction

- [#024 Glessner House from the north-east, July 1948 \(Robert C. Florian\)](#): Image is original porte-cochere doors (GX112.10), not northeast exterior.
- [#136 Glessner House courtyard looking west toward the stable wing, July 1948 \(Robert C. Florian\)](#): Image is roof/dormers/stair turret (GX112.24), not courtyard toward stable.
- [#137 Glessner House porte-cochère doors, July 1948 \(Robert C. Florian\)](#): Image is elevated courtyard toward stable (GX112.21), not porte-cochere doors.
- [#138 Glessner House roofs and stair turret from the courtyard side, July 1948 \(Robert C. Florian\)](#): Image is an industrial interior (GX112.28-29), not roof/turret; exclude from exterior geometry.
- [#112 Glessner, John J., Residence — 18th Street, c. 1900 \(D. G. Lowe collection\)](#): Disputed attribution: image shows two brick-gabled coach houses, inconsistent with independently

documented Glessner granite stable. Catalog also assigns Glessner; quarantine pending reconciliation, do not assert another identity.

- [#089 Glessner, John J., Residence \(1800 S. Prairie Ave.\) — Main Entrance Door. Sheet #95A](#): Drawing variant marked Not Correct; do not use its floral grille as built condition.
- [#033 Glessner House courtyard, watercolor rendering](#): Design watercolor, not proof of the built conservatory or fountain.
- [#035 Photocopy of preliminary design](#): Preliminary unbuilt central-gable scheme.
- [#126 Glessner house plaster model \(WPA Museum Extension Project\), east side](#): WPA model photograph; secondary reconstruction, not house photograph.

Examples of repeated exposures include #004/#005, #006/#103/#110, #007/#108 and #008/#101/#109. Taylor #9974 also appears in multiple printed/postcard derivatives. These are useful reproduction variants, not independent confirmations.

Proposed work items — review before queueing

26 draft items: 2 evidence prerequisites, 22 construction/research/finish packages, and 2 final verification gates. “Verify first” means the audit has identified a question, not proved the existing geometry wrong. Suggested order: evidence → enclosure/ground and verified geometry → materials/joinery → vegetation/lighting → browser and photographic sign-off.

[Download ticket review CSV](#) · [Structured draft JSON](#) ·

ID	Priority	Proposed work	Basis
GA-01	P0	Repair source identity, captions and evidence families	Evidence correction
GA-02	P0	Establish a dated, camera-matched exterior acceptance baseline	Verification prerequisite
GA-03	P1	Close the south courtyard boundary and resolve its junctions	Confirmed visible gap
GA-04	P1	Restore Prairie frontage curbs, thresholds and ground contact	Confirmed visible gap
GA-05	P1	Correct roof tile scale, continuity and distance rendering	Confirmed visible gap
GA-06	P1	Refine ridge caps, cresting, finials, eaves and flashing	Confirmed detail simplification
GA-07	P1	Validate roof, dormer and courtyard-bay proportions before further reshaping	Verify first — no established dimensional defect
GA-08	P1	Finish stable cupola and north loft fittings	Visible simplification; detail verification required

<u>GA-09</u>	P1	Make street granite read as coherent rock-faced masonry	Confirmed visible gap
<u>GA-10</u>	P1	Calibrate courtyard brick and limestone as distinct materials	Material verification and refinement
<u>GA-11</u>	P1	Refine exterior window frames, reveals, sash and stone supports	Confirmed repetition; dimensions to verify
<u>GA-12</u>	P1	Give dark glazing believable exterior-visible depth and variation	Confirmed visible gap
<u>GA-13</u>	P1	Correct mirrored north inscription and finish carved stone/capitals	Confirmed visible defects
<u>GA-14</u>	P1	Complete the main entry oak door and iron grille	Confirmed visible gap
<u>GA-15</u>	P2	Finish both porte-cochere leaves, hardware and passage	Existing doors; detail verification and refinement
<u>GA-16</u>	P1	Reconstruct the curved courtyard hall steps and cheek wall	Confirmed visible gap
<u>GA-17</u>	P2	Audit basement grilles, light wells and service openings	Verification and detail completion
<u>GA-18</u>	P2	Refine copper roof panels, seams and weathering	Confirmed detail simplification
<u>GA-19</u>	P2	Complete gutters, rainwater heads, downpipes and attachments	Confirmed detail simplification
<u>GA-20</u>	P1	Resolve chimney phase and finish stack/cap detail	Verify first, then refine
<u>GA-21</u>	P2	Date and finish courtyard service stairs, rails and rear gate	Verify first, then refine
<u>GA-22</u>	P1	Finish courtyard paths, edging, lawn and drainage	Confirmed simplification; surface chronology required
<u>GA-23</u>	P1	Add restrained, dated courtyard vines and exterior planting	Confirmed absence; exact coverage inferred
<u>GA-24</u>	P1	Balance lighting, contact shadows and restrained surface aging	Confirmed rendering gap; calibration required
<u>GA-25</u>	P1	Validate full/light browser quality and controlled performance	Completion gate
<u>GA-26</u>	P1	Run final photographic comparison and evidence sign-off	Completion gate

▼ GA-01 · P0 · Repair source identity, captions and evidence families

Evidence correction · Effort M · DRAFT — NOT QUEUED

Finding: Four Florian records point at the wrong subjects. The Lowe stable attribution is disputed; preliminary designs and model photographs can be mistaken for as-built evidence.

Proposed work: Correct the four view captions/asset associations; retain original catalog metadata and an audit trail. Quarantine #112 for geometry pending reconciliation. Flag rejected/design-only sheets, date ranges and duplicate exposures; retain rights restrictions. Ingest the three additional Florian views only after provenance/rights review.

Acceptance

- Each of the 168 records has an explicit review state, date/phase and evidence role.
- Correct #024 → doors, #136 → roof, #137 → court-west, #138 → industrial interior; recheck against original gallery.
- No affected geometry uses disputed #112 or the Not Correct door design; duplicate prints do not count as independent corroboration.

Evidence: [#024 Glessner House from the north-east, July 1948 \(Robert C. Florian\)](#); [#136 Glessner House courtyard looking west toward the stable wing, July 1948 \(Robert C. Florian\)](#); [#137 Glessner House porte-cochère doors, July 1948 \(Robert C. Florian\)](#); [#138 Glessner House roofs and stair turret from the courtyard side, July 1948 \(Robert C. Florian\)](#); [#112 Glessner, John J., Residence — 18th Street, c. 1900 \(D. G. Lowe collection\)](#); [#089 Glessner, John J., Residence \(1800 S. Prairie Ave.\) — Main Entrance Door, Sheet #95A](#); [#035 Photocopy of preliminary design](#); [#037 Facade \(watercolor\)](#); [#047 Glessner, John J., Residence \(1800 S. Prairie Ave.\) — Prairie Avenue Elevation](#); [#126 Glessner house plaster model \(WPA Museum Extension Project\), east side](#); [#127 Glessner model, north elevation](#)

Current views: source review

Dependencies: None

Existing work: New proposal

▼ GA-02 · P0 · Establish a dated, camera-matched exterior acceptance baseline

Verification prerequisite · Effort M · DRAFT — NOT QUEUED

Finding: The audit captures expose visual gaps but are not photogrammetrically matched; absolute dimensional errors have not been measured.

Proposed work: Create calibrated front, northeast, north, northwest stable, west, courtyard east/west and detail cameras. Register HABS dimensions and photograph control points. Assign attested/inferred/reconstructed status per feature for 1904-07-01.

Acceptance

- Use at least 8 matched views and 8 well-distributed landmarks per suitable view; record lens/crop uncertainty and residuals.
- Proposed target: reliable silhouette/opening landmarks within 1% of projected building width; any exception documented, not hidden by camera fitting.
- Separate design, 1887–1904 fabric, later alteration and restoration; a later photo alone does not prove a 1904 addition.

Evidence: [#008 Glessner, John J., Residence \(1800 S. Prairie Ave.\) — view from NE \(J. W. Taylor #2135\)](#); [#104 Glessner House stable/coach-house end on 18th Street, c. 1887 \(Cornell A. D. White collection; as reproduced by the museum\)](#); [#106 Female servants' entrance at Glessner House \(photograph by George Glessner\)](#); [#107 Porte cochere doors \(photograph by George Glessner, about 1888\)](#); [#114 Glessner, John J., Residence — Main reception hall](#); [#118 Interior court](#); [#144 2. First floor plan - John J. Glessner House, 1800 South Prairie Avenue, Chicago, Cook County, IL](#); [#146 4. Section A-A - John J. Glessner House, 1800 South Prairie Avenue, Chicago, Cook County, IL](#); [#156 6. Front \(east\) elevation - John J. Glessner House, 1800 South Prairie Avenue, Chicago, Cook County, IL](#); [#142 John J. Glessner House, HABS IL-1015, written historical and descriptive data \(27 pp.\)](#)

Current views: prairie, north, west, courtyard, roof

Dependencies: GA-01

Existing work: Extend/reuse T-1843 acceptance infrastructure; do not duplicate its metric contract

▼ GA-03 · P1 · Close the south courtyard boundary and resolve its junctions

Confirmed visible gap · Effort M · DRAFT — NOT QUEUED

Finding: The audited scene opens the courtyard to surrounding grass; the continuous south enclosure is absent. Museum documentation attests a common-brick wall with vines since 1887.

Proposed work: Build the documented enclosure, coping and returns; reconcile its height and shared relationship with 1808 from plans/sections. Join the west gate, stable and house without duplicate faces or gaps. Exact hidden construction remains inferred.

Acceptance

- Continuous historically supported enclosure in courtyard, overhead and street-through-porte views.
- Measured plan alignment and declared height basis; no floating gate piers, overlaps or missing backs.
- House boundary ownership agreed with the existing district package.

Evidence: [#118 Interior court; #137 Glessner House porte-cochère doors, July 1948 \(Robert C. Florian\)](#); [#144 2. First floor plan - John J. Glessner House, 1800 South Prairie Avenue, Chicago, Cook County, IL](#); [#142 John J. Glessner House, HABS IL-1015, written historical and descriptive data \(27 pp.\)](#)

Current views: southwest, court-east, court-west, roof

Dependencies: GA-02

Existing work: Coordinate with T-1935 and T-1882/T-1883; house enclosure is a specific subtask, not a second stable or neighbor build

▼ GA-04 · P1 · Restore Prairie frontage curbs, thresholds and ground contact

Confirmed visible gap · Effort M · DRAFT — NOT QUEUED

Finding: Grass runs directly to the main door and through the porte-cochere in the current captures. The characteristic rounded stone edge/access gaps are absent.

Proposed work: Model the house-side grass-strip curb, entry approach, stone thresholds and carriage passage surface. Tie grades to surveyed/HABS datums and period photos; coordinate public sidewalk ownership.

Acceptance

- Main door and porte access have continuous credible surfaces, no grass through the passage.
- Curved curb sections and access gaps agree with period views, with joints and end returns.
- No floating, buried or z-fighting thresholds at street-eye level.

Evidence: [#008 Glessner, John J., Residence \(1800 S. Prairie Ave.\) — view from NE \(J. W. Taylor #2135\)](#); [#013 Glessner House Prairie Avenue front, with the O. R. Keith house \(1808\) at far left](#); [#107 Porte cochere doors \(photograph by George Glessner, about 1888\)](#); [#115 Front elevation](#); [#144 2. First floor plan - John J. Glessner House, 1800 South Prairie Avenue, Chicago, Cook County, IL](#)

Current views: entry, porte, prairie

Dependencies: GA-02

Existing work: Coordinate T-1728 street/sidewalk scope and T-1745 legal-lot datums

▼ GA-05 · P1 · Correct roof tile scale, continuity and distance rendering

Confirmed visible gap · Effort L · DRAFT — NOT QUEUED

Finding: Broad banding dominates the street roof; overhead views show large smooth roof planes beside dense tile patterns. The material does not read consistently as fine overlapping clay tiles.

Proposed work: Use the HABS 6-inch width/5-inch exposure as a measured lead, checked against early photos; separate later tar treatment from the original unglazed red clay. Correct UV scale, overlap, roughness, mip filtering and full/light transitions on every roof plane.

Acceptance

- Tile courses remain coherent across hips, turret cones and dormers, with no abrupt smooth-to-tiled patches.
- No distracting moire or broad striping during camera movement at street, courtyard and overhead distances.
- Source-backed scale and original-material interpretation recorded; no assumption that 1960s tar coating existed in 1904.

Evidence: [#008 Glessner, John J., Residence \(1800 S. Prairie Ave.\) — view from NE \(J. W. Taylor #2135\); #104 Glessner House stable/coach-house end on 18th Street, c. 1887 \(Cornell A. D. White collection; as reproduced by the museum\); #136 Glessner House courtyard looking west toward the stable wing, July 1948 \(Robert C. Florian\); #161 Glessner House: west roof and hayloft dormer \(Richard Nickel, 1966–67\); #142 John J. Glessner House, HABS IL-1015, written historical and descriptive data \(27 pp.\)](#)

Current views: prairie, northeast, roof, west

Dependencies: GA-02

Existing work: New proposal

▼ GA-06 · P1 · Refine ridge caps, cresting, finials, eaves and flashing

Confirmed detail simplification · Effort M · DRAFT — NOT QUEUED

Finding: Ridge cresting exists, but its repeated small forms and thin roof edges understate the photographed caps, terminals and layered eaves.

Proposed work: Refine existing profiles and spacing; add credible edge thickness, valley/abutment flashing and hip/ridge terminations. Preserve repaired roof connectivity.

Acceptance

- Count/profile/spacing checked against two usable views wherever available.
- No razor-thin exposed edges, open valleys or intersecting cap chains at close range.
- Front and courtyard silhouettes preserve T-2016/T-2157/T-2183 fixes.

Evidence: [#008 Glessner, John J., Residence \(1800 S. Prairie Ave.\) — view from NE \(J. W. Taylor #2135\); #104 Glessner House stable/coach-house end on 18th Street, c. 1887 \(Cornell A. D. White collection; as reproduced by the museum\); #118 Interior court; #136 Glessner House courtyard looking west toward the stable wing, July 1948 \(Robert C. Florian\); #161 Glessner House: west roof and hayloft dormer \(Richard Nickel, 1966–67\)](#)

Current views: roof, west, courtyard

Dependencies: GA-02, GA-05

Existing work: Refinement of completed roof work, not reopening its solved intersections

▼ GA-07 · P1 · Validate roof, dormer and courtyard-bay proportions before further reshaping

Verify first — no established dimensional defect · Effort M · DRAFT — NOT QUEUED

Finding: Complex dormer flares, bay roof shoulders and service-roof intersections need camera-matched checks. Recent roof corrections already shipped.

Proposed work: Measure roof pitches, dormer positions, hood flares, turret/bay height and copper shoulder profiles against as-built records. Change geometry only for documented residual errors.

Acceptance

- Produce dimension/control-point table and matched comparisons.
- Retain correct work; list any necessary corrections individually with source confidence.
- Do not import the preliminary central gable, watercolor conservatory or fountain.

Evidence: [#104 Glessner House stable/coach-house end on 18th Street, c. 1887 \(Cornell A. D. White collection; as reproduced by the museum\)](#); [#118 Interior court](#); [#136 Glessner House courtyard looking west toward the stable wing, July 1948 \(Robert C. Florian\)](#); [#144 2. First floor plan - John J. Glessner House, 1800 South Prairie Avenue, Chicago, Cook County, IL](#); [#145 3. Second floor plan - John J. Glessner House, 1800 South Prairie Avenue, Chicago, Cook County, IL](#); [#146 4. Section A-A - John J. Glessner House, 1800 South Prairie Avenue, Chicago, Cook County, IL](#); [#161 Glessner House: west roof and hayloft dormer \(Richard Nickel, 1966–67\)](#).

Current views: west, courtyard, roof

Dependencies: GA-01, GA-02

Existing work: Protect T-1805/T-1830/T-1833/T-1999/T-2016/T-2157/T-2172/T-2183

▼ GA-08 · P1 · Finish stable cupola and north loft fittings

Visible simplification; detail verification required · Effort M · DRAFT — NOT QUEUED

Finding: The cupola reads as a simple brown louver box; the early stable photo shows a more articulated vented structure. A final close-up confirms the 1/3/5 pigeon-opening array already exists; the projecting loft hoist/perching fittings need refinement or completion.

Proposed work: Reconstruct cupola silhouette, roof and vent/openwork profile from early stable and later detail photos; inventory and finish loft opening, hoist beam, pigeon openings/perch and stable-door joinery. Date later closed-up loft changes.

Acceptance

- Matched stable views agree on cupola tier proportions and vent pattern.
- Every visible loft fitting is represented or explicitly ruled out with evidence; do not infer from disputed #112.
- No 20th-century blocked loft or replaced stable door silently backdated to 1904.

Evidence: [#104 Glessner House stable/coach-house end on 18th Street, c. 1887 \(Cornell A. D. White collection; as reproduced by the museum\)](#); [#161 Glessner House: west roof and hayloft dormer \(Richard Nickel, 1966–67\)](#); [#142 John J. Glessner House, HABS IL-1015, written historical and descriptive data \(27 pp.\)](#).

Current views: northwest, north, detail:stable-gable, detail:west-roof

Dependencies: GA-01, GA-02

Existing work: New proposal

▼ GA-09 · P1 · Make street granite read as coherent rock-faced masonry

Confirmed visible gap · Effort L · DRAFT — NOT QUEUED

Finding: Close-ups show noisy faceted stone and highly uniform joint treatment; at street distance the texture overwhelms coherent masonry. Shaded walls lose the intended rock-face relief.

Proposed work: Refine block coursing, face projection, dressed margins, joints and corner/opening returns using Wellesley-granite evidence. Keep texture scale physical and separate stone variation from lighting.

Acceptance

- Long/short block distribution, course heights and opening returns align with reference zones.
- Rock-face silhouettes and joints remain legible at street distance without random triangulated sparkle.
- Review front and shaded north/west under both neutral diagnostic and actual scene lighting.

Evidence: [#008 Glessner, John J., Residence \(1800 S. Prairie Ave.\) — view from NE \(J. W. Taylor #2135\)](#); [#106 Female servants' entrance at Glessner House \(photograph by George Glessner\)](#); [#114 Glessner, John J., Residence — Main reception hall](#); [#115 Front elevation](#); [#116 18th Street arch](#); [#117 Detail: gable and chimney 18th Street side](#); [#142 John J. Glessner House, HABS IL-1015, written historical and descriptive data \(27 pp.\)](#)

Current views: prairie, entry, north, west

Dependencies: GA-02

Existing work: New proposal

▼ GA-10 · P1 · Calibrate courtyard brick and limestone as distinct materials

Material verification and refinement · Effort M · DRAFT — NOT QUEUED

Finding: The current courtyard reads dark brown with bright uniform trim. HABS identifies light pink common brick and Joliet limestone, distinct from street granite.

Proposed work: Calibrate brick dimensions, bond, mortar, roughness and pinkish color range using written evidence and documented surviving fabric. Give limestone lintels/sills their own finish; do not extract color from black-and-white photos.

Acceptance

- Material identity and scale are recorded per surface.
- Brick bond wraps corners and openings coherently; trim does not resemble smooth white plastic.
- Compare neutral-light and actual-scene renders; color uncertainty remains explicit.

Evidence: [#118 Interior court](#); [#139 Glessner, John J., Residence — exterior \(Florian, July 1948\)](#); [#142 John J. Glessner House, HABS IL-1015, written historical and descriptive data \(27 pp.\)](#); [#151 North elevation — inclined: left stereopair](#)

Current views: courtyard, court-east, court-west

Dependencies: GA-02

Existing work: New proposal

▼ GA-11 · P1 · Refine exterior window frames, reveals, sash and stone supports

Confirmed repetition; dimensions to verify · Effort L · DRAFT — NOT QUEUED

Finding: Window panes use repetitive dark fields and simplified frame profiles. The front grouping is already present; this audit does not establish a wrong opening count.

Proposed work: Inventory every exterior opening by elevation; refine sash sections, meeting rails, recess depths, mullions, sills, drip edges and varied stone columns/capitals. Verify central upper front four-light group against HABS rather than guessing five.

Acceptance

- Opening schedule covers front, north, stable, west, bay, turret, dormers and basement.
- No duplicated sash configuration where source photographs show a different type.
- Matched shadows and profiles read correctly at street and detail distances.

Evidence: [#008 Glessner, John J., Residence \(1800 S. Prairie Ave.\) — view from NE \(J. W. Taylor #2135\)](#); [#115 Front elevation](#); [#118 Interior court](#); [#146 4. Section A-A - John J. Glessner House, 1800 South Prairie Avenue, Chicago, Cook County, IL](#); [#151 North elevation — inclined: left stereopair](#); [#156 6. Front \(east\) elevation - John J. Glessner House, 1800 South Prairie Avenue, Chicago, Cook County, IL](#)

Current views: prairie, entry, north, courtyard

Dependencies: GA-02

Existing work: Preserve completed T-2172/T-2183 window/eave relationships

▼ GA-12 · P1 · Give dark glazing believable exterior-visible depth and variation

Confirmed visible gap · Effort M · DRAFT — NOT QUEUED

Finding: Windows appear as nearly identical dark blue-gray panels with repeating diagonal shading; historical images show varied shades and surface response.

Proposed work: Keep the owner-selected dark default. Add restrained reflection/roughness variation, appropriate shade positions and shallow backing visible from outside. Match documented special hall glass where supported; no furnished interiors.

Acceptance

- Avoid identical repeated shade/reflection patterns across the facade.
- Default remains dark and performs within agreed budget; no reinstatement of the costly glass mode by default.
- No empty bright boxes, opaque painted-on highlights or visible sky leaking through rooms.

Evidence: [#008 Glessner, John J., Residence \(1800 S. Prairie Ave.\) — view from NE \(J. W. Taylor #2135\)](#); [#013 Glessner House Prairie Avenue front, with the O. R. Keith house \(1808\) at far left](#); [#115 Front elevation](#); [#118 Interior court](#); [#151 North elevation — inclined: left stereopair](#)

Current views: prairie, entry, courtyard

Dependencies: GA-11

Existing work: Respect T-2109 and T-2183 dark-glass decision

▼ GA-13 · P1 · Correct mirrored north inscription and finish carved stone/capitals

Confirmed visible defects · Effort L · DRAFT — NOT QUEUED

Finding: The close north-gable view confirms the 1886 inscription is mirrored from outside. The front tympanum and ornamental band exist, but relief, edge wear and varied capitals need close-range fidelity.

Proposed work: Refine existing ornament against actual photographs; use relief at appropriate distances. Correct the mirrored 1886 inscription and check the monogram handedness from the exterior.

Acceptance

- Ornament remains recognizable in matched close-ups, with correct silhouette and varied capital patterns.
- Inscription reads correctly from outside; record the check.
- No added ornament based solely on rejected/preliminary drawings.

Evidence: [#008 Glessner, John J., Residence \(1800 S. Prairie Ave.\) — view from NE \(J. W. Taylor #2135\); #115 Front elevation; #117 Detail: gable and chimney 18th Street side; #135 Glessner, John J., Residence — removal of the Graphic Arts Technical Foundation sign \(Richard Nickel\); #156 6. Front \(east\) elevation - John J. Glessner House, 1800 South Prairie Avenue, Chicago, Cook County, IL](#)

Current views: entry, prairie, north, detail:north-gable

Dependencies: GA-01, GA-02, GA-09

Existing work: New proposal

▼ GA-14 · P1 · Complete the main entry oak door and iron grille

Confirmed visible gap · Effort M · DRAFT — NOT QUEUED

Finding: The current main door has a plain square grid and simplified lower field. Photographs and HABS describe heavily paneled oak with iron straps and a distinctive grille.

Proposed work: Build the as-built grille/central scroll, hardware and raised-panel profiles; refine frame, threshold and oak grain. Resolve drawing variants against the built-door photograph.

Acceptance

- Door panel proportions, grille and hardware match the built reference, not sheet #95A marked Not Correct.
- Grain follows separate members and panel directions; iron has thickness and attachments.
- Threshold/door recess joins the frontage correctly.

Evidence: [#088 Glessner, John J., Residence \(1800 S. Prairie Ave.\) — Main Entrance Door. Sheet #95;](#) [#089 Glessner, John J., Residence \(1800 S. Prairie Ave.\) — Main Entrance Door. Sheet #95A;](#) [#090 Glessner, John J., Residence \(1800 S. Prairie Ave.\) — Main Entrance Door. Sheet #95A;](#) [#135 Glessner, John J., Residence — removal of the Graphic Arts Technical Foundation sign \(Richard Nickel\);](#) [#142 John J. Glessner House, HABS IL-1015, written historical and descriptive data \(27 pp.\)](#)

Current views: entry

Dependencies: GA-01, GA-04, GA-02

Existing work: New proposal

▼ GA-15 · P2 · Finish both porte-cochere leaves, hardware and passage

Existing doors; detail verification and refinement · Effort M · DRAFT — NOT QUEUED

Finding: Both open leaves are present. Their open pose obscures a full panel comparison; the passage currently has grass. This is not a request to add missing doors from scratch.

Proposed work: Inspect each leaf front/back in open and diagnostic closed poses. Match the photographed panel grid, rounded/beveled recesses, straps, ring pulls, edge thickness and hinges. Finish passage soffit, reveals and paving.

Acceptance

- Both leaves match the 1888 photograph including panel counts and hardware; no invented grille.
- Open pose clears masonry without clipping; a closed diagnostic pose aligns at the meeting stile.
- 2023/2024 replacements are restoration aids, not independent proof of 1904 condition.

Evidence: [#024 Glessner House from the north-east, July 1948 \(Robert C. Florian\)](#); [#107 Porte cochere doors \(photograph by George Glessner, about 1888\)](#); [#142 John J. Glessner House, HABS IL-1015, written historical and descriptive data \(27 pp.\)](#)

Current views: porte, court-east

Dependencies: GA-01, GA-04

Existing work: Coordinate museum porte-cochere restoration documentation

▼ GA-16 · P1 · Reconstruct the curved courtyard hall steps and cheek wall

Confirmed visible gap · Effort M · DRAFT — NOT QUEUED

Finding: The bow entrance currently has simple white stacked steps. HABS photograph and section show shaped descending masonry beside the steps.

Proposed work: Model the curved/stepped brick cheek, caps, treads, landing and door threshold from the section and photograph; resolve the exact curvature by matched view.

Acceptance

- Step count/rise/run and cheek profile agree with the plan/section within stated tolerance.
- No floating treads, missing side faces or grass intersecting the landing.
- Brick and stone join naturally to the bow and courtyard path.

Evidence: [#118 Interior court](#); [#144 2. First floor plan - John J. Glessner House, 1800 South Prairie Avenue, Chicago, Cook County, IL](#); [#146 4. Section A-A - John J. Glessner House, 1800 South Prairie Avenue, Chicago, Cook County, IL](#)

Current views: courtyard, court-east

Dependencies: GA-02, GA-10

Existing work: New proposal

▼ GA-17 · P2 · Audit basement grilles, light wells and service openings

Verification and detail completion · Effort M · DRAFT — NOT QUEUED

Finding: Front stone grids already exist. Courtyard dark barred openings appear deep/tall in current views and need source-based proportion checks.

Proposed work: Inventory lattice/grille dimensions, setbacks, wells, basement vents, doors and drainage edges. Distinguish window, vent and passage openings; refine only demonstrated differences.

Acceptance

- Every basement opening is cross-referenced to elevation/plan and assigned a type.
- No missing well bottoms, see-through voids or inconsistent grille thickness.
- Any courtyard opening resize follows matched evidence, not a visual guess.

Evidence: [#008 Glessner, John J., Residence \(1800 S. Prairie Ave.\) — view from NE \(J. W. Taylor #2135\)](#); [#106 Female servants' entrance at Glessner House \(photograph by George Glessner\)](#); [#118 Interior court](#); [#144 2. First floor plan - John J. Glessner House, 1800 South Prairie Avenue, Chicago, Cook County, IL](#); [#148 "Granite block old home of late J. J. Glessner at 1800 Prairie av." \(Chicago Tribune, January 31, 1965\)](#); [#156 6. Front \(east\) elevation - John J. Glessner House, 1800 South Prairie Avenue, Chicago, Cook County, IL](#)

Current views: entry, north, courtyard, court-west

Dependencies: GA-02, GA-09, GA-10

Existing work: New proposal

▼ GA-18 · P2 · Refine copper roof panels, seams and weathering

Confirmed detail simplification · Effort M · DRAFT — NOT QUEUED

Finding: The copper bows are recognizable but read as large uniform green surfaces with sparse seam detail.

Proposed work: Refine panel division, folded joints, edge rolls, flashing and roughness variation; document the uncertainty of 1904 patina. Preserve continuous roof geometry and repaired shoulder joins.

Acceptance

- Seam layout and edge profiles agree with available photographs; no arbitrary oversized panels.
- Patina varies plausibly with water flow without uniform green paint or unsupported black-and-white color sampling.
- No seams lifted off surfaces, overlaps or breaks at adjacent roofs.

Evidence: [#118 Interior court](#); [#136 Glessner House courtyard looking west toward the stable wing, July 1948 \(Robert C. Florian\)](#); [#151 North elevation — inclined: left stereopair](#); [#142 John J. Glessner House, HABS IL-1015, written historical and descriptive data \(27 pp.\)](#)

Current views: courtyard, roof

Dependencies: GA-02, GA-07

Existing work: Protect T-2157 and T-2183 copper continuity

▼ GA-19 · P2 · Complete gutters, rainwater heads, downpipes and attachments

Confirmed detail simplification · Effort M · DRAFT — NOT QUEUED

Finding: Visible downpipes are simplified thin rods; historical images show articulated heads, offsets, gutter edges and brackets.

Proposed work: Inventory each documented drainage run, hopper, elbow, collar, strap and discharge. Give metal thickness and believable connections at roofs and grade.

Acceptance

- Each visible run has continuous roof-to-discharge logic, with no floating rods.
- Locations and decorative shapes follow photographed evidence; uncertain concealed runs remain labeled.
- Gutters/flashings cast credible close-range shadows without excessive geometry.

Evidence: [#008 Glessner, John J., Residence \(1800 S. Prairie Ave.\) — view from NE \(J. W. Taylor #2135\)](#); [#118 Interior court](#); [#151 North elevation — inclined: left stereopair](#)

Current views: prairie, courtyard, court-east

Dependencies: GA-06, GA-18

Existing work: New proposal

▼ GA-20 · P1 · Resolve chimney phase and finish stack/cap detail

Verify first, then refine · Effort M · DRAFT — NOT QUEUED

Finding: Street stacks are present. Two courtyard service stacks were explicitly reconstructed in prior work; their 1904 attestation remains a research question.

Proposed work: Create a dated stack register; check the two service stacks and any vents against early photos/plans. Refine stone bonds, offsets, coping and flue treatment where supported. Do not delete inferred stacks without evidence.

Acceptance

- Every stack is classified attested/inferred/reconstructed with dates and sources.
- Any positional or count change is justified independently of later altered roofs.
- Caps and flues read as masonry construction without generic repeated slots unless documented.

Evidence: [#008 Glessner, John J., Residence \(1800 S. Prairie Ave.\) — view from NE \(J. W. Taylor #2135\)](#); [#104 Glessner House stable/coach-house end on 18th Street, c. 1887 \(Cornell A. D. White collection; as reproduced by the museum\)](#); [#118 Interior court](#); [#136 Glessner House courtyard looking west toward the stable wing, July 1948 \(Robert C. Florian\)](#); [#142 John J. Glessner House, HABS IL-1015, written historical and descriptive data \(27 pp.\)](#).

Current views: roof, north, courtyard

Dependencies: GA-01, GA-02

Existing work: Follow-up on T-2016 reconstruction decisions

▼ GA-21 · P2 · Date and finish courtyard service stairs, rails and rear gate

Verify first, then refine · Effort M · DRAFT — NOT QUEUED

Finding: A service landing and rail already exist. Later records contain altered stairs and doors; the HABS plan labels a 1955 wooden stair behind the stable, which is not automatically the courtyard service stair.

Proposed work: Separate each stair/landing/gate in a dated component register, preserve documented early fabric and refine iron profiles, posts, hinges, thresholds and masonry piers.

Acceptance

- No later stair is silently inserted into 1904 and no original stair is removed because another was added in 1955.
- Rails attach to landings and posts with plausible joints; gates connect to the enclosure.
- Hidden or uncertain details remain replaceable and labeled.

Evidence: [#137 Glessner House porte-cochère doors, July 1948 \(Robert C. Florian\)](#); [#144 2. First floor plan - John J. Glessner House, 1800 South Prairie Avenue, Chicago, Cook County, IL](#); [#146 4. Section A-A - John J. Glessner House, 1800 South Prairie Avenue, Chicago, Cook County, IL](#); [#142 John J. Glessner House, HABS IL-1015, written historical and descriptive data \(27 pp.\)](#)

Current views: court-west, southwest

Dependencies: GA-02, GA-03

Existing work: New proposal

▼ GA-22 · P1 · Finish courtyard paths, edging, lawn and drainage

Confirmed simplification; surface chronology required · Effort M · DRAFT — NOT QUEUED

Finding: The court is a flat lawn and plain gray strip. Later photographs include changed surfaces; HABS records institutional paving for parking.

Proposed work: Reconstruct the 1904 path/drive alignment from early evidence; refine hard surface texture, lawn edging, grades and drainage. Document any inferred paving type rather than copying 1948/1960s surfaces.

Acceptance

- No grass in carriage routes or at building thresholds.
- Lawn/path transitions and perimeter edging agree with the chosen dated evidence.
- Surface choice is separately sourced from geometry; later parking pavement excluded.

Evidence: [#118 Interior court](#); [#137 Glessner House porte-cochère doors, July 1948 \(Robert C. Florian\)](#); [#144 2. First floor plan - John J. Glessner House, 1800 South Prairie Avenue, Chicago, Cook County, IL](#); [#142 John J. Glessner House, HABS IL-1015, written historical and descriptive data \(27 pp.\)](#)

Current views: court-east, court-west, roof

Dependencies: GA-02, GA-03, GA-04, GA-16

Existing work: New proposal

▼ GA-23 · P1 · Add restrained, dated courtyard vines and exterior planting

Confirmed absence; exact coverage inferred · Effort M · DRAFT — NOT QUEUED

Finding: The house is bare of vines in the audited scene. Written history records courtyard Virginia creeper and Boston ivy on the front; later photographs are heavily overgrown.

Proposed work: Create a plausible July 1904 vegetation state using earliest dated photographs and planting history. Include branch/stem attachment and selective leaf coverage; coordinate frontage trees with the district.

Acceptance

- Coverage is dated and confidence-labeled; 1948 overgrowth is not copied wholesale.
- Plants do not conceal unresolved modeling defects or enter windows/gutters indiscriminately.
- Seasonal color, leaf scale, shadows and full/light cost are checked in actual browser views.

Evidence: [#008 Glessner, John J., Residence \(1800 S. Prairie Ave.\) — view from NE \(J. W. Taylor #2135\)](#); [#013 Glessner House Prairie Avenue front, with the O. R. Keith house \(1808\) at far left](#); [#016 Prairie Avenue \(Taylor #9974\), looking south from 18th St.](#); [#118 Interior court](#); [#137 Glessner House porte-cochère doors, July 1948 \(Robert C. Florian\)](#); [#142 John J. Glessner House, HABS IL-1015, written historical and descriptive data \(27 pp.\)](#)

Current views: prairie, courtyard, court-west

Dependencies: GA-02, GA-03, GA-10, GA-22

Existing work: Frontage tree context coordinated with T-2159; no new neighborhood ticket

▼ GA-24 · P1 · Balance lighting, contact shadows and restrained surface aging

Confirmed rendering gap; calibration required · Effort M · DRAFT — NOT QUEUED

Finding: Bright front texture and very dark blue-shaded north/west surfaces make materials read inconsistently. The house/ground interface lacks convincing variation.

Proposed work: Compare neutral material diagnostics with actual July scene light; tune ambient contribution, exposure, normals, contact shadows and roughness. Add evidence-based soot/runoff/dirt in joints and sheltered zones, with the 17-year building age in mind.

Acceptance

- Stone relief stays readable in shade without flattening sunny facades or crushing blacks.
- Contact shadows anchor the building, steps and enclosure without halos or detached dark bands.
- No baked double shadows, random grunge or deterioration copied from the neglected mid-century house.

Evidence: [#008 Glessner, John J., Residence \(1800 S. Prairie Ave.\) — view from NE \(J. W. Taylor #2135\); #115 Front elevation; #118 Interior court; #142 John J. Glessner House, HABS IL-1015, written historical and descriptive data \(27 pp.\)](#)

Current views: prairie, north, west, courtyard

Dependencies: GA-05, GA-09, GA-10, GA-12, GA-18, GA-22

Existing work: New proposal

▼ GA-25 · P1 · Validate full/light browser quality and controlled performance

Completion gate · Effort M · DRAFT — NOT QUEUED

Finding: This audit checked 1600×1000 full desktop stills only. Captures booted without page errors or failed requests and reported within-budget draw/triangle counts; paused animation means FPS=0 is not a performance measurement.

Proposed work: Reuse the metric/browser contract for full and light assets, motion, desktop and mobile. Test distance transitions, texture filtering, clipping, picking and actual frame timing after visual work.

Acceptance

- Repeat front/oblique/rear/roof views at 1280×800 desktop and 390×780 mobile, plus close details.
- Measure moving-frame performance on a declared device; keep agreed draw/triangle/texture/load budgets and owner dark-glass default.
- No missing detail at LOD transitions, flicker, errors, failed assets or UI-dependent rendering changes.

Evidence: [#142 John J. Glessner House, HABS IL-1015, written historical and descriptive data \(27 pp.\)](#)

Current views: prairie, northwest, courtyard, roof, entry, porte

Dependencies: GA-03 through GA-24 as applicable

Existing work: Reuse T-1843 acceptance framework; do not create parallel test infrastructure

▼ GA-26 · P1 · Run final photographic comparison and evidence sign-off

Completion gate · Effort M · DRAFT — NOT QUEUED

Finding: Passing a technical gate is not evidence that the house matches photographs. Exact 1904 color and hidden fabric cannot be proven from the available black-and-white record.

Proposed work: Deliver fixed-camera reference/render pairs and a discrepancy register for silhouette, openings, materials, ornament, ground, vegetation and lighting. Review all elevations and declare remaining uncertainties.

Acceptance

- All high-priority visible discrepancies resolved or explicitly accepted with a reason.
- No unreviewed courtyard/rear face; include sunlit, shaded, near and distant views.
- Label attested versus inferred details and present a photo-quality result without claiming unsupported historical perfection.

Evidence: [#008 Glessner, John J., Residence \(1800 S. Prairie Ave.\) — view from NE \(J. W. Taylor #2135\);](#) [#104 Glessner House stable/coach-house end on 18th Street, c. 1887 \(Cornell A. D. White collection; as reproduced by the museum\);](#) [#106 Female servants' entrance at Glessner House \(photograph by George Glessner\);](#) [#107 Porte cochere doors \(photograph by George Glessner, about 1888\);](#) [#115 Front elevation;](#) [#118 Interior court;](#) [#144 2. First floor plan - John J. Glessner House, 1800 South Prairie Avenue, Chicago, Cook County, IL;](#) [#146 4. Section A-A - John J. Glessner House, 1800 South Prairie Avenue, Chicago, Cook County, IL;](#) [#156 6. Front \(east\) elevation - John J. Glessner House, 1800 South Prairie Avenue, Chicago, Cook County, IL;](#) [#161 Glessner House: west roof and hayloft dormer \(Richard Nickel, 1966–67\)](#)

Current views: prairie, northeast, north, northwest, west, courtyard, court-east, court-west, roof, entry, porte

Dependencies: GA-25

Existing work: House-only sign-off; whole-street photography additionally depends on existing T-1882/T-1883/T-1935/T-2159 context work

What “photographic quality” should mean here

Use the proposed camera/landmark tolerances in GA-02 as a review target, then judge silhouettes, opening geometry, unique ornament and physical material scale in both shaded and sunlit views. Require complete rear/courtyard faces, clean roof junctions, plausible ground contact and stable appearance in motion. Historical accuracy and visual realism are separate checks: an attractive image must not conceal an undocumented change.

Black-and-white photographs do not establish exact colors or patina. HABS written data supplies strong material evidence: original unglazed red roof tiles; Wellesley granite on street fronts; light pink common brick and Joliet limestone toward the court (PDF pp.14 and 22). Its later roof description mentions tar treatment, and its alteration history records courtyard paving for parking (p.3). These phase distinctions must survive into the final model.

Do not automatically redo the recently repaired bay/eave geometry, add a preliminary central gable, replace the chosen dark glass default, remove inferred stacks without evidence, or recreate later institutional signs, parking surfaces and overgrowth in 1904.